

Winding Tree

Winding Tree and CoinFund's 9 Core Value Propositions of Crypto Networks



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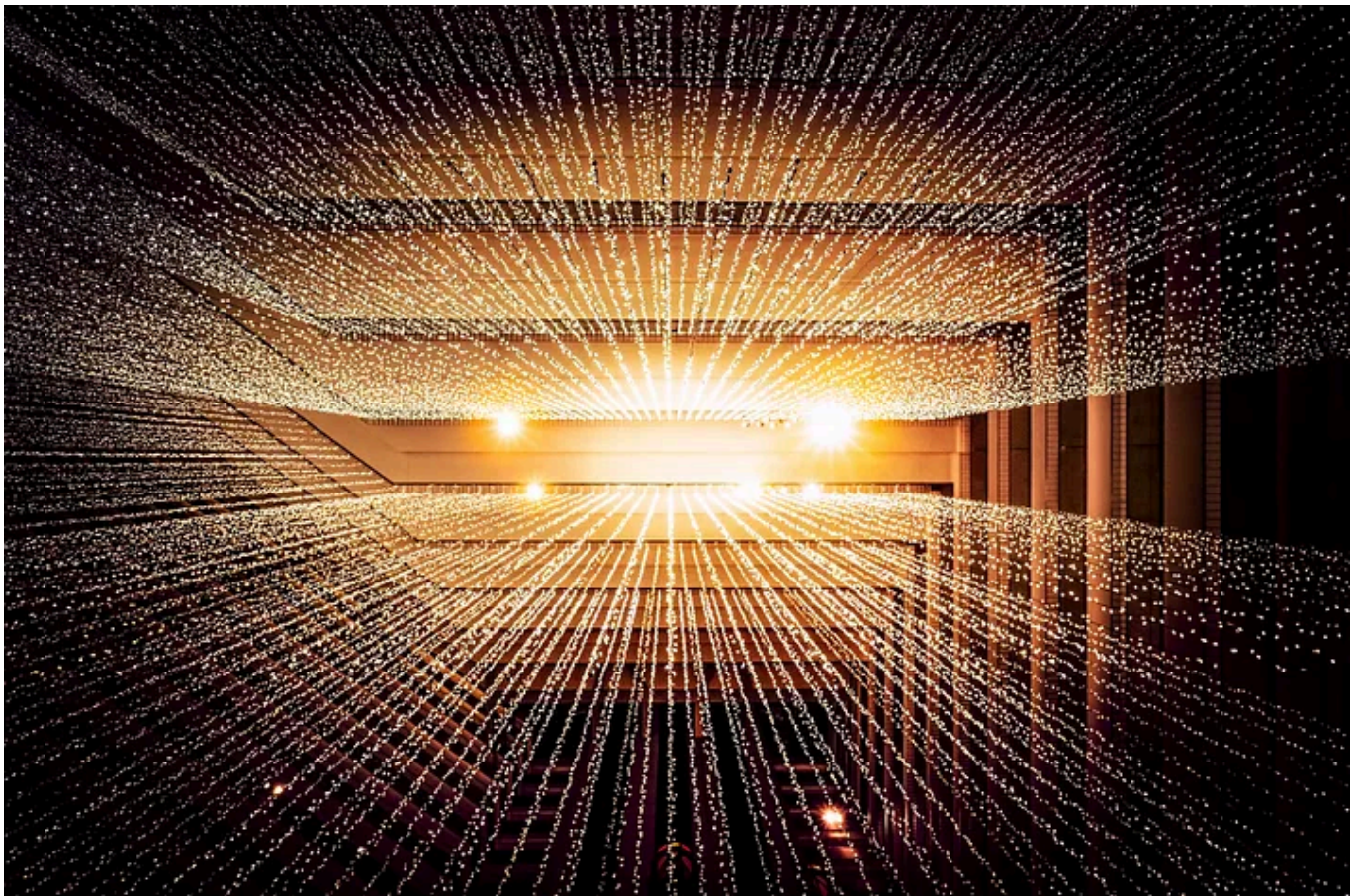


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Reading the [latest post from Jake Brukhman of CoinFund](#) (highly recommend to follow both), I couldn't help myself and try and analyze Winding Tree using their framework. But what is the question that this model is supposed to help you find an answer to? According to Jake's post, it's this: is the crypto network in question a transformative innovation that will outpace legacy products? So, how would we score? Let's take Winding Tree apart and see.

No1 Permissionlessness, censorship resistance

Well, this one is quite obvious. The travel industry is centralized, and many of its problems stem from that: there are the gatekeepers and the censors. Winding Tree was created because of that, this was our motivation.

As Jake said, "Open, permissionless crypto networks compete with centralized incumbents who use their monopoly power to skew open markets and co-opt the platforms upon which commerce is progressing, often disadvantaging their own customers." Quite an accurate description of the current state of travel industry.

How does Winding Tree fare in this regard? At the core of the platform, there is a smart contract called [ORGiD Registry](#). It lives on Ethereum and it can be accessed by anyone, no one has the ability to prevent anyone else from accessing the contract. The code of the smart contract is open source, and all the interfaces we've built to interact with it are open source as well: Arbor, ORGiD Resolver, etc.

As it's the early stages of the network, there is just one account that controls the smart contract. Why is this necessary? The smart contract will be constantly evolving, so we need to update it once in a while, adding new functionality or fixing bugs. We already have a [DAO](#) (Distributed Autonomous Organization) smart contract prepared, and we're waiting for the network to have a critical mass of players in order to unload the burden of controlling the smart contract to the community. The community will be deciding how the marketplace will be evolving.

Verdict: we're not quite there yet, but we're working on it!

№2 Borderlessness, global access

The borderless nature of crypto networks naturally flows out of their permissionless nature. If a certain country was banned from accessing, say, Ethereum, it would not be permissionless, would it?

Winding Tree, because it is truly permissionless, has no physical boundaries. Companies from any country in the world have access to it.

Verdict: pass with flying colors.

№3 Public governance, governance-as-software

No decentralized network can exist without an inclusive and transparent governance mechanism. Blockchains don't just allow this kind of new arrangement, it requires it. In this sense, Winding Tree is not just a technological innovation, but also an entirely new type of organization that is controlled by its users, via the Winding Tree DAO.

Verdict: can't wait to release the DAO!

№4 Political decentralization, regulatory arbitrage

Jake says: "Political decentralization refers to the ultimate owners of network hardware, software, and assets."

One of our goals is to introduce crypto into travel, something we've been doing since 2016. And we'd love to see companies, big and small, participating and profiting from this new economy. The ways the travel community can do this are truly endless, from providing their hardware to Ethereum to contributing to open source projects, participating in DeFi, etc.

"One of the most disruptive aspects of political decentralization is that it creates large-scale regulatory arbitrage."

It is one of the most incredible properties of decentralized networks: they can't be stopped. If the community of DAO participants decided that they want to operate based on certain rules, it will be so.

Verdict: DAO, we need you!

No5 Capture resistance

Capture resistance is a feature of a decentralized governance mechanism that prevents a small number of people from monopolizing power. It could be forks, or ragequitting, as Jake describes. One of the important and unique protection mechanisms that we have in place, in addition to “contentious forking”, is the fact that one company on Winding Tree has one vote, regardless of the size of the company.

Verdict: everything we do is open source from day one, anyone can fork our software or smart contracts.

No6 Mutualization, secondary markets

Mutualization is a fancy word for describing a state in which an organization (or a network, in our case) is owned by its customers.

Verdict: Winding Tree is designed to be controlled by its platform participants.

No7 Privacy, security

I'm not sure why this is number 7, because this is such an important aspect of our digital lives today. Winding Tree pioneered decentralization in the travel industry by providing end-to-end encryption for transactions, and by breaking up data silos and honeypots. With Winding Tree, hacks of major travel companies, which happen with horrifying regularity, is a thing of the past.

Verdict: Travel companies already can communicate using end-to-end encryption, without relying on central-storage honeypots.

No8 Trustlessness, outcome certainty

While Ethereum enables trustlessness by providing cryptographic guarantees about the transaction outcome (e.g. I know that I received a payment with an ever-increasing probability of a guaranteed outcome, because each new block makes it harder for a malicious actor to rewrite the blockchain), there are still uncertainties around whether I should even send the transaction in the first place. How do I know that the recipient is not a scammer that just pretends to be my business partner? Winding Tree's ORGiD is a toolbelt that allows the participants of our decentralized marketplace to make educated decisions about the trustworthiness of their potential business partners. It is one of the pillars of intermediary power, they claim that only they know who you should do business with, while their processes are extremely inefficient and costly.

Verdict: ORGiD extends the trustless capabilities of Ethereum.

No9 Cryptoeconomics, recursive incentives

What is cryptoeconomics? It is an aspect of a crypto network that is concerned with the creation of incentives for all parties that need to be involved in it, using smart contracts, tokens, etc.

Our cryptoeconomic designs are still in progress, and we're looking forward to testing them in real life. What do we have in place in this department? Well, we have Líf staking as protection against spam. Another device that's in the works is our partnership with Kleros.io, a decentralized arbitration protocol. It allows marketplace participants to assess potential new entrants and either allow or decline or even revoke, their participation in the marketplace. Líf staking is an integral part of this process as well.

Verdict: Everything is in place, we just need to package and release the governance platform.

Feedback

What do you think about this self-grading experiment? How would you grade other decentralized marketplaces? Let’s discuss it in comments, on [Twitter](#), or in our [Telegram](#) group.

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